

Researcher: Before we start, how would you like us to name your partner?

Participant: To remain anonymous?

Researcher: However you prefer us to call her during the interview.

Participant: My partner or by her name, [Partner's Name].

Researcher: Okay, very well.

Participant: It doesn't matter, no preference.

Researcher: Great. How long have you been with [Partner's Name]?

Participant: Since [Year]. We met in [Year]. We started dating in late [Year], on [Date].

Researcher: I'd like you to tell me about your love story, about your current relationship.

Participant: Currently? Since [Year], how it has evolved?

Researcher: Exactly, the whole story.

Participant: The whole story? It's a very rich story. That's the first term that comes to mind. Because we've experienced a lot, ups and downs. We have been parents to [1-5] children since [Year]. It started a bit shaky, actually, because when I met her, she was married. I didn't know that. We met at a... I was a recent graduate. I graduated in [Year]. It was through an evening event at [Event], the [company]. And then, I sent her an email because she had given me her business card, telling her that I liked her a lot and that I would like, if she wished, for us to meet again. And so, from there, things went well. Despite the fact that she was married, she was also interested. It felt strange to her. She wasn't expecting to be courted, as they say, by someone. It boosted her ego a bit because she wasn't necessarily feeling well in her relationship at the time. And the marriage was very recent for her as well. So, it was tough for the first [1-5] years at that level. [1-5], [1-5] years at that level, because it took that long for her to get divorced as well. Afterward, she described her relationship with her husband, her ex-husband, as smooth. It was calm, but there was no reason to hold anything against each other. So, we started living our relationship [1-5] year after our meeting. I don't remember if I moved or not. I was living with a friend at the time. I moved, so it was easier for us to see each other. It was good. She, later on, moved as well. She remained married all this time, as I mentioned, because it took [1-5] years. But again, [1-5] year, it was work that led her to move and get a house in [Location]. So, I made the trips. And yes, she came to [City] to see me as well. That was during the first [1-5] years. After that, we got a house together, still in [City]. And I worked in [Company]. I have quite a bad memory for dates, sorry. So, yes, we stayed in [City] for, I don't know, a bit less than [1-5] years. Because after that, professionally, we felt very, very bad. We no longer found ourselves in our respective jobs, and it impacted the couple a lot. She was in the field of professional training,

she was a [occupation]. And where she worked in [City], she was exploited. Considering her involvement, it was exhausting and tiring for her. And I, being the same, a [occupation] by training and working in that field, in the couple, we were injecting a lot of our bad memories, our bad daily experiences. We couldn't inject anything positive. So, that's when I also advised her at the time to see someone, to see a [occupation] to relieve the couple and make sure that I wasn't the only person she talked to about this, so we could say something else. And it was very badly received by her at the time because I was... She really considered me as the first man she could talk to, to have untangled... I don't know how she will talk about it on her side when she does the interview, but she often said that I was the person, the only person who helped her really express herself. So, it was very hard for her to push her away or to make her understand that she had to talk to other people because I wasn't always the best person for that and because the stakes of a couple's relationship are different when it's just between two people. So, yes, it was the first break in her mind for her. So, it created tensions afterward, and we physically separated. I came back to [City], and she did too. We considered ourselves separated. Let's say we took a break at that time. As I said, we stayed a little less than [1-5] years under the same roof in [City]. So, I was living with a couple of friends of mine, and she had a similar pre-accommodation in [City]. So, yes, my co-living situation eventually went bad because it wasn't the direct friends, it was other people. They rented their place, and I was with people. So, it went badly. I came back to her while I wanted to keep my distance as well. I wanted us to heal our wounds and for her to realize she needed to talk to someone else. But at the same time, she was, in a way, the only person I could really count on. So, it was very difficult. It was very difficult, this ambivalence. So, it lasted until a friend who owned a place offered me a place. Yes, because I didn't specify that in the meantime, we resigned after leaving [City]. So, it was very difficult for me to find a place to live because I didn't have a job. So, a friend who owned a place offered me a place. And so, it allowed us to see each other a bit more calmly. So, we got back together, knowing we had some past grievances. But yes, we didn't live under the same roof since the arrival of our [1-5] children, which happened... I think we moved in together again in [Year], because the eldest was born in [Year]. And yes, roughly. Afterward, I can go into more detail when you ask me questions. But yes, from [Year] to today.

Researcher: So, it was a relationship that was debated, and after the arrival of your children, it brought you back together.

Participant: If after another major element, it comes to mind. Before the children arrived, I wanted us to separate officially because I no longer found myself in the relationship with her. She went through a phase when she moved back to [City] where she had health problems. And it followed in succession. That is, she had surgery for a cyst in her ovaries, in her uterus. And after that, it went well. But then followed a phase where her mother had cancer too. So, for her, it was quite difficult psychologically. Her mother recovered too. But for her, it was quite hard psychologically. It was hard for me too to position myself in that. And I found that the support I tried to provide her, on the one hand for myself, had its limits because I could no longer support her. It was very difficult morally. And yet, I was somewhat repulsed. I know there were words that marked me. She told me at the time that if I had been present on the day of her operation, it was for my own interest, that it was for my own image. And I resented her at the time. And it

was the accumulation of all this that made me want to move on. And it also took time for her to divorce. We weren't on the same timeline. And I told her that I had met someone with whom nothing had happened. It was just a friend, a person I had befriended. But that I was attracted to her. So, it was already very hard for me to tell her. It was very hard for me to tell her. Because you have to assume everything that can result from that, meaning separating, meaning being alone too. And when I managed to tell her, it was a bit catastrophic for her. That I wanted us to separate. So it didn't happen overnight. At first, she told me, give me time. She wanted to try to make me a sort of plan over [1-5] months. She told me, look, I gave you a parachute, you still haven't used it, it would be nice if it were the last one. I'll just accompany you for that. And it was very hard because I wanted it to happen not overnight, but quickly. Because it's a period that is hard. It keeps me in a state where things are not clear. And so, we spent the following months in this in-between. And in the end, I lost my grandmother too in the meantime. And in this in-between, we continued to have this somewhat unclear relationship. We had a moment, and it was the moment when she told me she was pregnant. So, it happened at a time when psychologically, it wasn't the right moment. I was telling her I wanted to separate. And she told me that. And in addition, it was at a time, I don't know if you know the series called "[Title]" on Arte, which was broadcast. We were watching an episode, and it was a moment where just like them, it was a couple who came in, one finds out she's pregnant, and she has a miscarriage. And she tells me just after. So, it was very hard because I was in the mindset of saying that I accompany you so that you handle this separation well, but I want us to separate. And in the end, she tells me that. So, it was a period that went from something uncomfortable but more or less controlled to something uncomfortable and where I found no way out. I blew a fuse, we argued a lot. We had a very insulting life even. And I told her, you can't tell me you want to keep it if it's to offer it this new living environment. I was born to divorced parents, and I know the weight of not having both parents on a daily basis. I know it can be hard too to have two people arguing all the time in front of you. But I suffered from the fact that my father, even if I saw him occasionally, was on the other side of [Country]. But I didn't want to give that to my children. And it's life that starts life seeing parents who just separated. Because my parents separated just when I was born, a little while later. From the moment we knew it until the deadline for abortion, it was a period where we just argued. And I was telling her that I wanted an abortion, and she didn't want it. Until the day when throughout this reflection, I was asking myself whether all the past elements, whether our story made it that there were no elements that justified in our couple a base that made it that we lived very high things too, beautiful things, that could assure us some solidity and learn to rebuild things, intimacy, proximity, complicity. Even though I don't always feel fulfilled with her, especially, but on other things, yes. Shouldn't we try to get closer despite everything so that we restart life at three on good bases? So, I came back to her telling her that I accepted that we reconnect as a couple, and a few moments before my grandmother's death, to her great happiness, to mine too, but yes, it was very rich emotionally, physically, and psychologically. Wait, I need to blow my nose, I'll turn off the mic for a second. So yes, the unfortunate thing is to bear arms, obviously. So yes, until the arrival of our first child. I will stay on the initial main question, which is the couple relationship. I will go deeper for you. So having a child, everyone says it, it changes relationships a lot. It was the case for us because it was very difficult. It didn't start on a good base, even though when I wanted to come back, I was full of real hope too. But having a child, it calls into question the values we can have together, each

on our side. And the pregnancy went rather well for her. I don't know how she will tell you, but from an external perspective and considering what could happen to other women, considering what happens elsewhere, there were no complications because the child was born with a good weight, with a very large weight too. It was especially that which complicated the birth rather than the pregnancy. It was hard for her in the end, the last weeks, yes. But yes, the pregnancy went very well. It was an opportunity for us to move back together a little while before, to find accommodation. And so the birth was much more difficult because for her, it was physically, she lost a lot of blood. The epidural didn't work at all. So she felt all the pain. And it was very difficult for her. And the recovery too, because she had follow-up problems with the epidural. In fact, she had what is called a cerebrospinal fluid leak. And she had what is called a blood patch, meaning that normally, we are supposed to close up where we do the lumbar puncture, where we do the epidural. And in fact, there was still fluid leaking. And so she had problems. The day after the birth, we had to bring her back to the operating room. So it was very, very, very difficult. She could no longer stand on her feet. There was the newborn baby. There was the in-laws there. And yes, it was very difficult. So it took time. It took time afterward to welcome everything, to welcome this newborn. [Name] by name, if you want to know, so we can name him. So yes, it was hard the first weeks, the first months, because there's the baby's rhythm that comes into all this. So the sleep that is completely offset compared to ours. The idea that she needed me to be there all the time, and that I had a hard time sleeping with three in the same bed. It was the case at the beginning because when I sleep at night, I don't look. I could crush the baby, even give a backhand to the side. So she tried to do a bit of both. Breastfeeding was very difficult for her too because she wanted, she had a breastfeeding plan. And we had a lot of pressure at the maternity about it because they told her that she wasn't feeding him, that he needed bottle substitutes. So psychologically, it was hard for us. So breastfeeding started very late for [Name]. And yes, so the nights he started to sleep here, plus the breastfeeding, it took its time. And I told her at some point that she told me it was hard for her to take him at night, to put him in bed. And sometimes she didn't want me to get up to rock him. Because she told me it took much longer than her putting him back on the breast and putting him to sleep on the breast. And she told me she was more comfortable when she left him in the bed. I told her I would start sleeping on the couch if she preferred. And she would tell me at night if she needed me. So it established a period where I slept on the couch at night for a very long time. And during the day, I slept in the bed. So the quality of sleep was better for her. And not having me next to her was bothersome. So what I experienced badly was not the fact of not being there. Because I sleep well. When I sleep, I sleep. I need to sleep. Not necessarily sleeping with her. As long as I have good moments with her during the day, sleeping together is something that is in the relationship. Sure, it's a plus, but not as much as for her. For her, it's something she really needs, actually. And it really showed in these moments that she really needed it. I really struggled to be present there. So it was tensions for us. Yes, about that, sleeping, sleeping. So I would come back sometimes. I tried to be there too. Until we could start having him sleep in his room. Yes. And so I could come back to the bed. And so, yes. From the moment he started sleeping, it was a little better. I could sleep in the bed again. And then, a short time after, because the second one came when [Name] was... They have a [16-20]-month age gap. Yes, [16-20]-month age gap, yes, [16-20]-month age gap. So, yes, when we had relations, we continued to have relations. At that level, it was announced quickly. And so it didn't have the same impact as the first time.

Because even though we had a lot of tensions, regarding what I was saying about [Name]'s sleep and all that. But [Name] developed very well. He is a child who, the big point that impacted us, apart from sleep, is the classic children's diseases. Colds, flus that take on them with fairly high consequences. So, because he was in daycare on [Date], so I don't remember how old he was. He was [11-15] months, [11-15] months. And he started to be regularly sick since then and still up to today. So, yes, [Name]'s development went very well. Which meant that when she told me about the second one, I didn't have the face of someone who was very happy. Because I think I was doing the dishes at that time. But we had always said that a single child, we would like to have a family of at least [1-5]. So, I said yes. I don't think I hesitated too much. For me, the frustration is that, if I look back at what I told you, I didn't want children. We had one. If I wanted one, I would have wanted girls, or at least one girl. But I didn't have a girl. So, that was also why I had that look on my face when she told me that. I wasn't immediately very happy. But afterward, with hindsight, anyway, you take it. And as long as they are healthy, you love them. So, I said yes. I said yes to the second one. No problem. And so, yes. The second pregnancy went more or less well. The delivery was a bit better than the first one. Because it was much less medicalized as well. With a much more present, much more reassuring care team. Just like the epidural, very difficultly. It didn't have too many effects. And she will go into more detail when you interview her. But yes, the second delivery. I was present for both. So, that was also important for her and for me. That was cool. I was able to help with the first one, the gynecologist to get the baby out. And with the second one, the midwife too. So, that was also a great pride in the bonding in those moments. Doing skin-to-skin and allocating time to the second one. So, yes. I think we bonded a lot with the second one. She told me things on the delivery table as well. That showed that, yes, despite the tensions of the first nights with the first baby, with [Name], and that despite everything, we were made for each other. Basically, that she loved me more than anything and me too. And that helped a lot with the second one. It helped a lot to welcome the second one in the best conditions. And so, he was already much easier to live with, the second one, than the first one. So, in terms of sleep, he slept a lot at first. It was much easier. We did a bit of both. Currently, we each sleep in the living room. And in the bedroom, it's really because we are all sick. So, we make sure not to contact each other. The eldest, [Name], he sleeps well in his room. But yes, otherwise, a bit for the same reasons, sometimes, to make it easier for him to sleep, I sleep on the couch, but I have reinvested the bed so that we can all feel good. Yes, that's also one of the first main points in the relationship. That and also what I didn't mention, was the relationship with the in-laws. Especially her parents, because I see my parents very little. But her parents, who have been present for better or for worse, during the first pregnancy, it was very difficult because they wanted to do well. I don't question that intention, but I often have the phrase that says "the road to hell is paved with good intentions". And it was often hell, despite the good intentions. Because I felt quite bypassed in what they wanted to do without consulting me. So, there were a lot of tensions with her parents. And she didn't really try to get involved in that. So for the second one, we made sure to welcome the second one by at least starting on some bases. We set things between her and me on how to manage her parents in all this. So, it happened. For the second one, they didn't come to the house, they rented an [Location]. They came occasionally to help us. And as a psychologist, I won't teach you, the helping relationship is something complicated. It's something that... You can't provide help to someone who doesn't

ask for it. They tended to bypass me by assuming I needed help at times when I didn't need it. And that it was implied for the good of the child and our good. So, it took me a while to make them understand, because it was difficult, that they weren't helping me. They weren't helping me, they were bypassing me and it did more harm than good. And so, for the couple's relationship, it was very impactful because it created distance, because [Partner's Name] didn't know where to place herself in all this. But yes, with the second one, it was a bit easier to manage, I'd say. Yes, those are points I needed to share with you to give you some elements of answer on this opening question about the couple's relationship, how it is and how it has been. So, yes, in the meantime, at least we are clear on this. She too, she changed her view on her parents, on a lot of things. She idealized them much less over time. Because she really, when she introduced herself at the time when I met her, as a daddy's girl. And so, she saw her father clash with me. It was difficult, but it became a bit more objective over time. And even more now that we have children. And so, yes, currently, I consider that our relationship, it has a lot of scars, but it is much more... maybe a bit more lucid on who we are. Really, I think she will be. I think she would say it too. What we are missing, what we would need to rebuild over time, is to find time for us personally. To find time for us two afterward. And the complicity we could have had in the past. What would also relieve me, so I worry less about her health, is that when she finds time, she takes time to heal in all senses of the word. So, whether it's resuming sports, doing things she likes for herself. Healing her diet too, when she can. But yes, progressively, because we don't recover from childbirth just like that. Especially with two when they are so close in time. But yes, when all this gets back in place, we will be able to get closer a bit more. But yes, we can still laugh together, still have relations together. So that's why I think we still have a base I think quite solid. We have values that are strong for us and that are common and strong in terms of ideology, in terms of education, in terms of politics, in terms of worldview, ecology. Yes, so that's this base that I consider to be quite solid in terms of intimacy. And that brings us a certain serenity. Yes, a certain serenity anyway. Yes, I think...

Researcher: No, no, great. So, now if you had to compare the quality of your couple relationship with that of your friends, what would you say?

Participant: Wow. Friends in the broad sense or friends who can also be couples?

Researcher: Couples, I would say. Yes.

Participant: Friends who are couples, yes. Yes, well, if you compare the quality of your relationship... With friends who are in relationships themselves.

Researcher: Yes, that's it.

Participant: Okay. Good question. It's already a phase, for the past [1-5] years, where we don't see anyone anymore, we live a bit in autarky. Lack of time. And the little we see, if we go to see them but... But I also specify that since we had our first child, [Name], all my friends, in any case, had children at the same time. So yes, I saw them less also for these reasons. So, if I had to compare the quality, because I see my friends as couples but also now as parents, so I don't

compare myself as a couple but as a parent with them, yes that's what has been added. I don't know how to compare myself with them. Already my friends, they are not friends for nothing. So, if I find myself... In any case, those who come to mind first... They are people with whom I find myself, with whom we find ourselves on many things. The one who comes to mind first, who is the godfather of my son, who is my best friend. He is a friend dear to my eyes and who is... And who therefore, that my conclusive [Partner's Name] loves a lot too. And so yes, his couple relationship is somewhat similar to mine because he has [1-5] children too, well, who are very big now. But with whom we exchanged a lot. Who reassured me a lot. Who helped me a lot during the phase where there was this decision on whether to keep it or not. And to answer your question... In terms of comparison, actually, it's funny because I always have this phrase in mind of... When I go through difficult times, how would this friend do? Yes. Because on many points, I wouldn't say I idealize him but... He has qualities that I would like to have sometimes. Yes. Especially in terms of patience, emotion management when it gets difficult. When we are very tested. He is rather someone very serene, very calm, very cool. Who never raises his voice so... So, it's cool. And yes, he is someone I compared myself to a lot. And what did you want to know? If I compare myself or if... No, if you had to compare really the quality of your relationship in general to the quality of the relationships your friends have.

Researcher: Afterward, it can also be on a personal level perhaps.

Participant: But our relationship in terms of quality, I find that it had good debates. There is another friend I confided in who told me we could write a bestseller with what I told. So yes, in a way that I... When I see, in fact, the children will be a bit of the illustration of everything we have lived. I find that the quality in the end is rather good because they seem to be quite serene and even rather advanced. Especially for [Name], he is... Yes, very advanced, very ahead, very adorable. And so I find that it is our relationship that reflects on him. So I find that despite everything, our quality is rather good and compared to other friends... No, I can't say it's better or worse. From what I know, from what they reflect to me, it's really different, that's the term. But it has been very testing, ours, physically and psychologically. It is very testing, exhausting. But would it be worse or better? No. I know that my friend, who at the same time, some time after, told me that he was also going to be a dad, but that he had difficult phases with his partner. He asked me, as a psychologist, if I could recommend people to him because he knew that the relationship and communication were going to change, in any case with his partner, and that it was difficult at that level. So yes, difficulties that I know they have experienced, even before having children. They have experienced them, so... But yes, at certain times in the relationship, when we go through difficult moments, we can have this feeling of saying "but it's only me who this happens to". "It's only me who this happens to, these difficulties." But yes, with hindsight, when we arrive, when the clouds pass and things move forward and are built, we say to ourselves that these difficult moments, in the end, they have been much more helpful than anything else. Because that's also my philosophy and my mentality of the couple, is that I am [36-40] years old and I have been in a relationship twice in my life. My previous partner, we stayed [6-10] years together, and with [Partner's Name], it will be [6-10] years next year. So yes, the same, [6-10] years this year. So despite the ups and downs, it was very difficult in a couple for me to separate because I felt that what I found fulfilling was to grow something and make

people evolve in the relationship. So to come back to your question about quality comparison, I think that no, despite the ups and downs, we gain in quality for me. In any case, I fight to gain quality. As time goes on, when we go through difficult experiences, we come out with a better quality, I think. It's testing, it's tiring, but the quality is better. It's difficult, but it's like a wine, you let it age, but the taste is better at the end. But no, I can't compare myself more than that.

Researcher: You were talking about your previous relationship, if you had to compare it to your previous relationship, what would you say?

Participant: I could talk for hours too, but already the two women are different, obviously. What could I say that could help you? Where to start? With my previous partner, whose name is [Name], we stayed together for about [6-10] years. We didn't know each other at the same point in our lives, so that also changes a lot in a relationship. When I came out of the relationship with [Name], I was already much more mature on what I didn't want to promise someone. What I learned in my relationship with [Name] is that there were things we could promise each other but didn't keep, or that I didn't keep, and vice versa. So if I have to compare the relationship, it's that already. I came out of the relationship with [Name] much more mature, that I was... it's going to sound cliché, but that one had qualities that I consider qualities that the other didn't have, and vice versa. They both share a core of values that I recognize, but for the first one, it was life projects that separated us. They also had a different timeline, meaning they had a common point that I didn't choose, which is that they both come from [Location]. And the first one, [Name], I met her, she was the one who got me started in [topic] because I was studying [topic], and she started a course in psychology, and so we followed each other as students throughout our [course]. And so, I surpassed her, so to speak, because between working as a student job, she had to repeat [1-5] year of her thesis or [1-5] year of her degree, I don't remember, and so at the end of studies, the projects of having children, of moving started to feel, and especially for her, what was important was to return to [Location]. And I didn't want to, I had already been there with her once, and I wanted us to take advantage of this freedom that the end of studies gives us to do something else, travel, but not immediately return to [Location]. So that brought us a lot of divergences, and it was hard because it was accentuated by the fact that her mother had a significant hold over her, and it weighed on me heavily because her mother didn't really know her. Her mother had abandoned her at first, leaving her with her grandmother, and she didn't care about her psychology studies, she didn't care at all. It was I who supported her in that, but she still sought her mother's approval for many decisions. So, it weighed on me, and when she told me she wanted to go back for that reason, the accumulation of these elements led to our separation, because I said, I can't hold you back in this, and neither can I.

Participant: So, she had this timeline where she had lived in [Location] and left very early, and she wanted to go back, whereas [Partner's Name] had lived in [Location] for a long time, and when she arrived in mainland France, she didn't want to return to [Location]. So, that was somewhat of a relief for me, not that she didn't want to go back later, but at least she didn't want to settle there again. That was a comparison that stood out to me as quite significant. The idea of moving, traveling, [Partner's Name] and I were on the same page, unlike [Name], and we did a lot of traveling, which greatly nurtured our relationship. Before being in a relationship, I could



travel on a small scale, but it was mostly with my grandparents on vacations, we traveled a bit around [Continent].

Participant: But with [Partner's Name], those were moments where we grew very close, we found a lot of complicity, whether in [Country], [Country], or [Country]. So, the comparison between the first and the second relationship, in terms of activities, mentalities, and the fact that I met [Partner's Name] at a time when she also needed to emancipate herself from her family, to say I want to enjoy my life for myself. And the family emancipation, the second link that held her back was her ex-husband at the time, and the fact that with me, I introduced this idea of positive insecurity, which did us a lot of good. It's something that, even now, I cultivate a lot and need—this concept of positive insecurity—more than she does, but it does us good.

Participant: The idea of change, change in general. So, the comparison between the two relationships, that's a major element. On other points, what else could I compare? In terms of other things I found with [Name] but not with [Partner's Name], the artistic dimension, I found it much more with my previous partner, [Name], than with [Partner's Name]. With [Name], she sang in a gospel group, and she loved singing, loved music, and she had me play [instrument] in this gospel choir, so those were things we found a lot of common ground in. And yet, what I'm saying isn't entirely true because [Partner's Name] also cultivates her artistic dimension, as her passion is poetry, literature. It was an opportunity for me to confront something I didn't know at all, but with a lot of clumsiness on my part. Because art is something intimate, and sometimes I would arrive like a bull in a china shop, as they say. I didn't really have the posture of a psychologist; I was trying to take my place in one of her worlds that belonged to her. As a result, sometimes she kept me at a distance, and it took her time to share everything—her poetry, her short stories. During the phase I mentioned when we were separating, before she was pregnant with [Name], she participated in a short story competition, writing short stories and all that. So, it was a whole new artistic scene for me, and in the end, it was just as enjoyable, and over time, it satisfied me.

Participant: In my conception of a couple, sometimes I would like the person I live with to be 100% in tune with what I do, share the same musical tastes, play the same instruments, but over time, I've learned to accept it, even if sometimes it's a bit difficult because we don't listen to the same music, don't do the same things. But that's what sets her apart from [Name] for me.

Researcher: Okay, yes, I see. And I would like you to talk to me about what a high-quality relationship means to you. Participant: A high-quality relationship is already, well, where there's a communication base, where one can confide in the other, really lay oneself bare, go ahead, sneeze if you like, where both can freely open up, truly talk about what they experience, what they go through. I think that's the foundation of a high-quality relationship. So, knowing each other, having the same language, speaking the same language, that's the basis for me that will define the solidity of a couple. And then in the relationship, well, it's the common points, the shared values, worldview, the environment in which we live. Does the environment where the partner lives also please us, do we feel good? Do we find ourselves in their circles, their networks? It's very personal, according to me, because I'm someone curious about the other. Being curious about the other can sometimes hurt the relationship in the sense that I can be a

bit too intrusive, and I fully recognize that, it has hurt our relationship at times. But to a certain extent, we need to find ourselves in each other's relationship.

Participant: So, that's what defines high quality, and vice versa, that she can find herself in what I live, what I share, what I feel, that we can support each other in difficult moments. And I think what's difficult to convey, as a person in a couple but also as a [occupation], is that the help we want to provide to the other is not necessarily about acting but also about keeping a distance. And that's hard to hear, but on the other hand, it's something I have experienced and think people in a couple need to understand. Sometimes, keeping a distance from the other is helping, it's helping the couple, it's helping the couple to maintain a good quality, a very good quality of relationship. It's difficult, very difficult, for me to experience and to make others understand, but it has better results, I think.

Participant: So those are the elements I consider to be the main criteria for a good quality couple. How do you know, for example, that you are in a relationship with good communication, that's transparent, clear? I'll take elements from communication psychology, meaning when the person in front of you reformulates and you find yourself in their reformulation of your words or ideas. So, all these markers of communication. When we share our desires, needs, and see that the other person can respond to them, either verbally or through actions, other actions, we see that the message has been understood. When we manage to keep a sense of humor, when we can laugh and say things while laughing, it shows that communication is good, that we manage to get the message across. It hasn't always been the case for us. When we manage not to get angry, not to be upset, it's been very difficult for us, at least for me, because I can get... well, I wouldn't say easily angry, considering our experiences. I think if I got angry, it was because I couldn't make myself understood or heard. But when a couple manages not to get to that point, it means communication is good, the message gets across, and both find themselves in the message that was intended to be conveyed.

Researcher: And when would you say your relationship had that kind of good communication?

Participant: Several times.

Researcher: Do you have an example?

Participant: Yeah, good communication. There's communication where we say things formally and also where, over time, we know each other and anticipate what the other needs and thus communicate our attention, the attention we give to what they might need, by doing things without them asking. For example, making coffee in the morning because I know she will get up before me. These can be markers of good communication, meaning I know what you will do, I know what you will experience, so I make these moments easier for you. These are more markers of informal communication. As for recent examples of good communication, I must admit that lately, our communication has been more about formal things, making appointments, very administrative. But do I have an example of good communication? It's difficult because now that we have children, we communicate a lot indirectly. We often communicate through our child, saying things like, "You know mom loves you, you know I love mom." Do we say it to each

other? We do, we hug a lot. At least I am someone very tactile. She is not as much, but I had to work a lot on expressing that this was something I missed. So, communication involves holding each other, that's good daily communication for me. We are sick, so we try not to kiss too much, but intimate relations are also a form of communication, whether we like it or not. Just last week, Friday, was the first day in [1-5] years that we were both home without the kids since our second child is now going part-time to daycare. So that was a moment where we could be physically present with each other. So, good communication is an example that doesn't necessarily involve words, but something I try to do, and she is aware of it too. She says, "I know you need it." So she comes to me, touches me, holds me. We make a point of doing this. She recently told me in the car, "I love it when you kiss my forehead in the morning."

Researcher: And on the contrary, do you have an example of poor communication? Participant: Yes, I have many examples. Poor communication. I am someone who doubts a lot, even more so now that we are both parents. We question ourselves a lot, we don't know if we are making the right choices. So, the comments she can make about my way of taking certain initiatives with our children, I might take them personally or see them as attacks. And so sometimes I will have incisive responses. I will reply coldly. There will be moments where our looks aren't the same, the tone of voice changes. So, those are markers of poor communication that will come back. This has caused many of our arguments. One of us felt misunderstood, or one wanted to ask the other for something, but it wasn't the right moment, or the other didn't want to or couldn't. For me, it was about being tired and exhausted and not wanting to. And so, my way of expressing poor communication was speaking in a certain way. She would tell me I spoke badly to her, and it's true, in a way, I did speak with... how I felt—anger or... often it was spontaneous, often cold remarks, leading to a period of distance that could be long or short. That's what made it hard to reconnect as a couple.

Researcher: Now, on the contrary, could you tell me what a low-quality relationship looks like to you? Participant: A low-quality relationship? Wow. I try to remember because I know people who have low-quality relationships. It's everything that's the opposite of what I have mentioned before. So, people who have nothing to do together, in the sense that they share no ideals, no values, who have no common points, who spend their time arguing, tearing each other apart, who might even resort to physical violence. I try to see if I have such people around me. And sometimes, what I mentioned might be obvious, but for some people, it's much more invisible. I take the example of my sister's relationship with her partner. For her, I think she is okay with it, or at least she doesn't say anything, but I have the impression they have no common points. When we are with them, they talk to us separately, but they don't talk to each other. At least, her partner is very jovial, very friendly with me, very kind with [Partner's Name] and our kids, but with my sister, they are on completely different planets, they don't talk, they remain very evasive. He isn't very communicative either, with me yes, but there's no communication. Low quality and communication are strongly correlated for me. Whether verbal or not, communication can take many forms, but if people can't freely open up to each other, feeling they must hide things... Everyone has things they want to keep to themselves, no problem, but at least feeling that the other person will accept that and not judge. So, a low-quality relationship lacks these foundations. And then, if we look at media, social networks, sometimes very superficial relationships emerge where appearance is the primary criterion. I'm not saying it isn't

a criterion; it counted for me too, but not just that. Superficiality is also a sign of low-quality relationships, I think, which are doomed not to last or at least struggle to last.

Researcher: You mentioned a lack of communication and shared interests. Has there been a moment in your relationship when there was a lack of shared interests? Participant: Yes, definitely. Over time, it happens, but with my view of relationship quality over time, it's more balanced now. I see the lack of interest as moments when I accept better what doesn't interest me about her, or the possibility, especially for her, to flourish without me. That's also hard to accept. In a couple, the idea that the other person can flourish without you. Also, the idea that she can't respond to all my needs. That's very difficult, but over time, I accept it better, and we find balance in other areas. There's an equilibrium. The hardest part is when you feel stuck in a phase. But the longer and richer our story, the more we can refer to past elements that bring us joy, complicity, and smiles.

Researcher: Could you talk about things that are important in a relationship besides communication and shared interests?

Participant: Yes. Sexuality is important. It's something that has helped us through difficult times. Traveling is another. For me, what's important is to be with someone who can adapt, someone who can adjust over time, through events and different contexts. [Partner's Name] is a very good communicator, very convincing, and that has greatly attracted me to her. Her communication skills open up a wider social spectrum for us, allowing us to live better. Being with someone who can adapt, especially through communication, is very important. Playing is another crucial element, in every sense of the word. I'm someone who loves to play, whether it's music, board games, or wordplay. So, playing is a key criterion in the relationship. Sexuality, playing, adaptability—these are the bases. If we have these, we're good.

Researcher: Based on your experience, what is love to you? It could be romantic love, friendship love. Participant: I often differentiate love and desire. Desire can be very physical, whereas love involves admiration, support, complicity, and attachment. Love is when someone values you, sees you at your best. It's the foundation of love for me. In my friendships, I feel this complicity and attachment. Feeling accepted in your most vulnerable state and being seen as beautiful is crucial. Safety and security are vital in a relationship. Without love, there's no relationship. Love involves safety, attachment, and valuing each other.

Researcher: How do you know your partner loves you? Participant: She often sends me positive signals, reassures me, especially in my role as a father. We've written to each other a lot, expressed our love through emails, texts, and poems. Physical contact, humor, and small gestures also show love. Even though I sometimes need to ask for reassurance, these actions affirm her love.

Researcher: Can you give an example of a recent positive interaction with your partner?

Participant: We hugged this morning; we made love on Friday. I complimented her soup yesterday. These small gestures and moments of complicity are positive interactions. Talking

about current events, having her attention, sharing emotional experiences—these make for positive interactions.

Researcher: What makes these interactions positive?

Participant: Having her attention, feeling that we are emotionally on the same page, sharing the same feelings about something—that's what makes an interaction positive. If I had someone in front of me who was in a completely different state, there would be an asymmetry in the relationship that would create a gap. If she had completely laughed it off, it would have made me understand that there wasn't a good exchange. So, really sharing the emotions and movements. Yes.

Researcher: And now, on the contrary, I would like you to talk to me about the latest negative interactions you've had.

Participant: Latest negative interactions we've had. Do I consider it negative or not? It's hard because it's my own perception, because she might tell you what she considers negative and it might not be the same for me. What do I consider negative? What might she tell you? If I say something that... Every day we might send each other little jabs, but I tend not to remember them. Text messages often help, if you want me to look at the texts to help remember, that might help, but... Sometimes in the markers of communication in certain texts... Oh yes! We went to Action, we needed to buy a new toilet brush, and while we were browsing the aisles, it was packed with people, and there were mouse pads nearby. She wanted a mouse pad, and I told her I'd buy her one there. So while I was looking around, she went off with [Name], and... I insisted on buying her a mouse pad because last time she wanted to borrow mine and she didn't have one. But I told her, it's not expensive, just get one, or I'll buy it for you so you have your own. You see, this is something I focus on daily, making sure the workspace is very ergonomic for her. That she doesn't have health problems, that she has her chair and all that. This can sometimes cause friction daily because... So she went with our son to get the toilet brush, and seeing that I was taking my time, she went to the toy aisle. When I got there, I said I wasn't taking long, I was just looking at things because I noted that I wanted to buy you a mouse pad. To me, it retracted there when she said she didn't need it, even though last time she said she would get one when the opportunity arose. But it was probably because there were so many people and our son was a bit agitated, and she said she didn't need it anymore. So [Name] got upset, she went out with him, and we didn't understand each other. So it was the misunderstanding that led to an argument.

Participant: So what made it a negative interaction was the misunderstanding. The misunderstanding plus the context in which it happened, the pressure from the crowd, sometimes the negative interaction is linked to the tension children can create. The fact that you have this divided attention, it's burdensome daily because you can't be fully present with the other person. You always have to keep an eye on what's happening. The older one is starting to be a bit autonomous in many ways. At least he walks, he can eat on his own. But the other one is not yet, he needs 100% attention. This makes it harder in the relationship to always have

positive interactions. It adds another parameter that puts you in a state of tension. You can't be fully in communication with the other.

Researcher: I'd like you to talk about the challenges you face in your life.

Participant: Challenges to face? Wait, let me clear my nose first because there's a lot to say. So challenges to face according to me in our relationship, right? Challenges to face, challenges to face. Trying to rebuild after this phase since our breakup, which wasn't really a breakup in the end. Trying to regain complicity and especially unconditional support in each other's eyes. Trying to find all that again, I think that will be the major challenge for the coming months and years. I think that's mainly the challenge ahead to reinforce the foundation of our relationship that might have eroded. And I think that consequently, all other aspects of the relationship will improve as well. But I think that's the foundation, that's really the challenge for the months and years to come. Yes.

Researcher: So rebuilding the foundation, consolidating the foundation.

Participant: Yes, which was tested during this period of false separation, during the pregnancy and birth period. The challenge will be to regain complicity beyond sexuality, as we know we have that. It will also be about the changes brought by the children, as the eldest will be [1-5] in [Month] next year and will start school. All that will affect the couple as well. Managing the children and managing us. We know we'll have more free time because the youngest will spend more time at daycare. How we will handle it? We've started to get a glimpse of it personally. Then we will share moments together, so the challenge will be how to reappropriate this time individually and as a couple. Professionally, we are in phases where a lot is changing for us. We've always had the common interest of traveling and considering international mobility. So, we will see if this is the right time to materialize that elsewhere. So, launching all that and seeing how it all coordinates. That will be a challenge for the relationship. The real challenge will be there. How all these aspects will be brought together again. That's the real challenge. There are several I mentioned.

Researcher: Have there been challenges you have already overcome in the past? In my relationship with [Partner's Name]?

Participant: Oh, challenges we've overcome? The steps we had to go through to be together were a challenge. That was clearly a challenge. Already, for her to leave her marital relationship, for me to accept it and live with that. That was a big challenge. A challenge for me was to find a way to accept her parents, and for her to accept my perspective on them. That's a real challenge. It's a challenge because I need to share what I feel without offending her, without her shutting down, without creating a taboo. That's a big challenge in terms of communication and relationship. Saying what you think without the other person shutting down. That's a very big challenge. So, we have faced that a lot. I use the example of parents because they are very important to her. But, making her understand what she has experienced and is experiencing with them, sometimes I find them more toxic. And it was a huge challenge for me because she didn't see it that way. She didn't hear me like that. So, it was a challenge to get

that message across. The challenge of being parents, too. I mean, from the time we had two little ones until now, we've overcome a lot. Recently, she mentioned something simple but meaningful, saying we don't have many friends to compare ourselves to, not because we don't want to, but we don't see them much. She said, word for word, I don't know if she said exactly this, but "I think we're doing well." Which makes me think yes, we have overcome the challenges we faced personally and as a couple and as parents. Yes, challenges we have overcome well.

Researcher: Now, let's change the dimension a bit. We know that in a relationship, not everything is always good. So, I'd like you to talk about the conflicts, the disputes that you face in your relationship. For example, the main issue that comes up most often?

Participant: Yes, something that often came up, which was even one of the first issues, is the relationship with food. When we met, I was 15 kilos lighter already. I was in a phase where I had taken up a lot of sports again, I was feeling good, feeling good in my body, good in my mind, coming out of my previous relationship, which had rather boosted me. And it has always been a somewhat sensitive subject because, for me, food—I can have an uncomplicated view of food if I feel I have a physical activity or sport to balance it out, to not worry about it. But when I can't balance it, which has been the case for some time due to lack of time, opportunities, and motivation, I become more mindful of diet, daily hygiene, and her hygiene too. Because I know she has a much sweeter tooth than I do, and I'm firmly convinced, as science shows, that sugar has effects, especially considering her health issues related to her cyst and other problems. I won't go into more detail, but I know sugar can feed cancerous tumors and has an inflammatory effect. At that time, she really didn't like sports, really didn't. She was very self-conscious because her father is a judo instructor and put a lot of pressure on her about it. I didn't want to add pressure, but I wanted to show that it had a positive effect on me and generally had a positive effect. But in the end, I did put pressure on her. So, that was the subject of many conflicts. She has evolved on this, maybe not in the best way because it happened under pressure. When we were in Kassandre, she started going to the gym. She saw the benefits for herself, which was positive for us too. But I would have liked it to become more systematic without me having to bring it up. I don't feel legitimate to say too much because, currently, I don't have time to do it myself. And as I said, I'm not the best example right now. But that has been the subject of many conflicts. In the couple as well, it was the first time I made a comment about her weight gain. That was very difficult. So that's one of the early conflicts in the relationship that has always been there to some extent.

Participant: The other conflict was about positioning towards parents. That was a conflict because it took her time to see that they didn't always have the best approach. For me, for the child. What was conflictual for me was that I felt disapproved of as a [occupation] in the relationship. And I never really managed, I clearly say it, I never found my place as a psychologist in the relationship because I felt discredited for what I said or contributed due to my training, my background. And I was very harsh, very cynical. It created a lot of bitterness in communication and in the relationship. Because it felt like I had to defend a thesis and provide study references every time to prove something. And so, it created a lot of tension in the relationship. And a lot of condescension as well. She felt that when I said, "It's not me saying

this, it's psychology, I'm not inventing it," it came across as very condescending. I can't position myself on that, maybe it was. Maybe my intentions were good, but as they say, the road to hell is paved with good intentions, and I didn't have bad intentions in the end. So that was conflictual, this relationship. My identity, the identity I wanted in the couple and my perspective as a psychologist that I wanted to bring in. Which I thought would be good for nourishing the relationship. Like when I told her I might not be the best person to talk to because I'm not neutral. Eventually, it's better to see someone else. That was also a conflictual period because of that. So, I mentioned some major conflicts that have lasted the longest over time. The relationship with the body and food with each other, the professional identity, the relationship with her parents. Mainly.

Researcher: And generally, how do you resolve these conflicts?

Participant: Discussion, communication. We had many periods of very virulent arguments. And other times, much more peaceful moments. Sometimes she set a good example of how to forgive. I still have a lot to learn from her in terms of apologizing more often. So, resolving conflicts involves apologizing for the tone, the way it was expressed. Even if it's hard to apologize because, as she knows too, anger has a reason. If we're angry, it's because there's frustration and misunderstanding behind it. And sometimes we feel like we've been fighting for years to express ourselves and find it hard to apologize after saying things already. So, it's a balance, apologizing, communicating, talking. It's also about actions, making up by doing things that were forgotten, knowing she'll notice. Doing something she hadn't thought of but will appreciate. She did that recently when she reminded me that next year it will be [6-10] years we've been together. So, resolving conflicts involves that too. Hugs, how to resolve conflicts, attention, small gestures of attention mainly.

Researcher: And what is the frequency of your conflicts? I should ask you for a grid in these cases. For example, in the last fifteen days?

Participant: In the last fifteen days, markers of conflict resolution, I can't tell you at all, really. I want to say it's not even the frequency, but their value. What I focus on because sometimes we might show a lot of small markers, and it won't resonate the same way for the other. Whereas sometimes we might say one word, and it won't erase everything, but almost. I don't know. Otherwise, the conflicts themselves?

Researcher: Markers that would have... Would you have a frequency of how many times you discussed for example in the last fifteen days?

Participant: In the last [11-15] days, we discussed the advertising. No. It happens in a way... I don't know. A kiss. Yes, no, I can't... Because, apart from the conflict you mentioned, then it's... Sometimes it also subsides without saying. The irritation doesn't resolve right away. It might resolve a few hours later, inviting the other to a restaurant, going out to eat. So it goes unnoticed in my head as a conflict resolution element. But maybe in the last [11-15] days, there have been four or five conflicts, and just as many resolutions following them. It happens at different times, with different resolutions. Yes, with different resolutions.



Researcher: I'd like you to talk about other ways you maintain your relationship, other than what you mentioned for resolving conflicts. Are there other ways you maintain your relationship?

Participant: Other ways? Other than what I mentioned to maintain the relationship?

Researcher: You talked a bit about attention, gestures...Yes, to maintain the relationship.

Participant: Actually, yes. I don't know, I'd be interested to know what she suggests. Maybe I'll ask her. To maintain the relationship, I think it's one of the things I do habitually without putting a word to it. It's projecting together actually. To maintain the relationship, it's about projecting together...together. It's mainly about imagining a future. Maintaining the relationship is about thinking, "How do I still see myself with her?" and including her in these thoughts. Including her or not at certain moments. Because, as I said, the relationship is about accepting that there will be moments when I won't be with her and vice versa. So, it's about including her in our projects. In our projects...that's not proper French, in my projects. But yes, it's about maintaining the idea that we are still connected. Simply put, that we will continue to experience life together. That we will discover new things. This helps to maintain the relationship. We have often lived by this project-based pedagogy. We've had a lot of mechanisms for projecting ourselves. For example, with travel, we would talk about wanting to go to certain places. Projecting about having children is a way to maintain the relationship. It means that what we project for ourselves includes the other as well. And this is a strong element. A strong element to say, "I still see you with me." "I still see you with me, so you are still connected to me in my vision of the future." And yes, that's something decisive. Something we still have today. What creates tension is that we don't know how we will achieve it. So, we are sometimes not in sync about this, which can create friction and misunderstandings. But the core of the project is a driving force that brings back the connection and helps resolve conflicts. The project.

Researcher: So, having common projects too. Yes, clearly.

Participant: On the contrary, I'd like to know what could make you leave your partner. Not having the same projects at all. Not feeling good in our relationship in terms of communication. Everything I've mentioned. Not finding myself with her anymore and vice versa. I know what strongly made me want to leave at one time was my tendency to shout. She had a relationship... whereas I sometimes felt... I was born into a family where my mother shouted a lot. I saw arguments that maybe I shouldn't have seen as a kid. So, she also experienced this. And it traumatized her. When I got angry, it was a predictive element for her. So that's something that made... I'm answering the opposite of your question, but I'll come back to it. What could make me leave... Divergence of projects, desire. Desire. She often asked me, "Will you leave me if you don't love me anymore?" I said, "I think I'll love you." I won't say always, but I think... I don't want to say always, but for a very long time. Desire is something different for me. So, it could make me less complicit with you and maybe lead to separation. What made me attracted to another girl at one time was the fact that we shared moments of complicity that we didn't share in terms of games. So leaving could be due to that. It could be the fact that I can't even imagine them. I couldn't even name them. She is not a mean person. As I said, she always has a kind look. But yes, it would be if she were malicious towards me. What made me want to leave was

the feeling of being discredited as a [occupation]. Because for me, it was a foundational aspect of my personality and gave me real confidence. And feeling discredited by her and her parents made me think we had nothing left together. I didn't recognize myself in that, and she didn't recognize me. Recognition is a key element. That was a major reason, more than desire or anything else. Because in my relationship with love and desire, I learned the term sapiosexuality a few years ago. I found that I related a lot to sapiosexuality too, regardless of the person's appearance. But to feel desire and love for someone, their intelligence, charisma, and the things they say must seduce me. If she no longer has that or doesn't convey it, then I'm not only physically attracted; if that's gone, it could be a reason for separation.

Researcher: So intellectual complicity. Intellectual complicity is strong. We like to think together.

Participant: Yes, yes, yes.

Researcher: So complicity on different levels and desire, which are important.

Participant: Yes, yes, yes.

Researcher: Would you say that this relationship is good for you? Do you feel it supports your functioning? Does it benefit me? Does it help me in the sense that it brings me something?

Participant: Yes, it does. It's part of my intellectual musings on whether I'm with the right person. Yes, I think it brings me something because it ties into your earlier question about challenges. It's a challenge because we have our differences, she and I, and our personalities mean that we sometimes have the same needs, but need different responses to fulfill them. So, the answers I give her might not be the right ones. The way I express myself might not be right. It's a challenge, and it brings me something because it forces me out of my comfort zone. It makes me work on how I handle things. For example, with anger, it brings out anger that I didn't have in my previous relationship, but it also forces me to manage it differently. It requires me to work on myself. And in this sense, it brings me something. This relationship helps me and challenges me.

Participant: An example of a specific situation? It's the accumulation of situations. It's not just one situation; it's the repetition. If I talk about anger management, it's the fact that she told me it's inconceivable to communicate by shouting. So, the repetition of situations has made me understand better or identify the things in me that weren't recognized, to make myself understood and get less angry. The fact that it reflects on the children. For example, our child knowing to say "I love you" and showing it, coming close to us for hugs. This shows that the difficulties we've overcome, even if it was hard, bring us something in the end. The moments of reconciliation are what we try to focus on. And she tries to highlight those moments. Even when we might have hurtful words, we try to end on a positive note. For a long time, I was the positive element, saying, "No, let's see the positive side, let's move forward." Now, she tries to bring positivity after the rain. So yes, that's an example that shows it brings something.

Researcher: Do you think you're the same person now as at the start of your relationship, or have you changed?

Participant: We are very categorical on this, we recently agreed on this. No, we are not at all the same person. I might not have let you finish, but no, we are not at all the same person. She and I have evolved. We are different now. For me, as parents. No, because our whole story has led us to reveal ourselves and to reposition ourselves, find a gauge, a cursor to say, "I didn't imagine this much or so little." So, yes, we're unanimous. We are clearly not the same person we were at the beginning.

Researcher: How have you noticed changes in yourself? In the previous question, you mentioned some positive changes.

Participant: Even if it's not always visible, in terms of managing frustration, it has helped a lot. When in a relationship, you do fewer things for yourself, and as a parent, even less. So, it has changed me in that way. What has changed? With time, you idealize the other person less. The image you have of the other person might be a bit devalued, but trying to keep a positive, maybe not romantic, but sensitive view. She might say romantic, but for me, it's sensitive. Despite the highs and lows, I wouldn't have stayed focused on the negatives. I've tried to maintain sensitivity towards her evolution.

Researcher: And do you feel she has changed in the relationship?

Participant: Yes, clearly. Her mentality, confidence, lack of confidence, the freedom of speech. She told me that I was the person who allowed her to speak, which she didn't have before our relationship. With time, we might become wary, but she's changed in that she doesn't share everything anymore. That was a hard change, finding the balance between speaking without overexposing.

Researcher: Do you feel safe in this relationship?

Participant: Yes. Given everything I've verbalized, yes, I feel safe. I try to complement this, but yes, we are not in the idealized love of the first [1-5] years where we didn't live together and had no stakes. Now, there are more stakes, so it feels heavier. But in terms of the nature of communication and the image the other reflects, I feel safe.

Researcher: Can you give a concrete example of a situation where you felt safe?

Participant: Recent example... How she manages her life. It's not just the look she has on me, but how she handles her professional and personal life, her aspirations, desires, and her role as a mother. What she can give me additionally is already good. An example is how she talks about her professional life, poetry, things she didn't share for a while. She bought a book by an author she discovered and seeing her enthusiasm reassured me.

Researcher: Lastly, let's discuss another dimension of relationships: sexuality. Its importance can vary. How does it play a role in your relationship?

Participant: Now with children, it's difficult. Planning gives us very little time together. Taking a shower together is considered part of our sexuality, bringing spice and complicity. So, yes, it's important.

Researcher: You said you have it less frequently. Can you provide a frequency?

Participant: Maybe three times in [1-5] months. Grand maximum. We are in [Month], yes, three times.

Researcher: Are you satisfied with your sexual life?

Participant: Satisfied with the partner, yes. Frequency, no. That's the nuance I'd add.

Researcher: Finally, I have a questionnaire for you. It's just small scales.

Participant: In general, does your partner really listen to you? From 1 to 9. I'd say 6.

Researcher: Why 6?

Participant: Availability, as we have kids. Sometimes, I ask her to call me by name first because sometimes she talks to me and I don't realize it's directed at me. My partner is generally attentive to my needs. Yes, I'd say 7.

Researcher: Why 7?

Participant: Even when she can't meet my needs, she makes sure I have time to address them.

Researcher: How satisfied are you with your relationship?

Participant: I'd say rather satisfied.

Researcher: Rate your satisfaction from -10 to 10.

Participant: I'd say 7.

Researcher: Why 7?

Participant: Because despite the ups and downs, many positive things keep building and moving forward, which justifies a positive score above 5. The gap between 7 and 10 is due to uncertainty about our future.